be a way for the US to alleviate its problem of how to include Beijing in the United Nations General Assembly without excluding Taipei, but he remained opposed. He thought the result would be a break with China, which India could not afford.[147]

One result of India's engagement with China was more American attention. In the aftermath of Nehru's visit to China, on Dulles's urging, Eisenhower wrote to Nehru stressing that "differences in approach [did not] constitute any bar to growing friendship and cooperation" between the US and India. There was a great amount of "common ground on which we can work out mutual problems and minimize differences." Nehru agreed, saying differences in approach were "natural," but "should not be allowed to come in the way."[148] Good intentions, however, were not enough to overcome the tensions generated by differences over their methods.

A key source of that tension—Indian engagement with China—continued, with a year of *Hindi-Chini bhai-bhai* (Indians and Chinese are brothers) culminating in China's coming-out party at the Afro-Asian conference in Bandung in April 1955. Publicly, Dulles said the conference was of no direct concern to the US. Privately, however, Allen, now the assistant secretary of state for Near Eastern, South Asian, and African affairs, told the Indian ambassador that the inclusion of China at the conference would not be "well received."[149] But Nehru had dismissed these objections and US pressure on the other organizers, insisting that China needed to be invited.[150] For him, as John Garver has observed, the conference was part of "creating political constraints" on China.[151] And at Bandung, Nehru found Zhou to be "accommodating" and countries like Pakistan and Turkey—spurred, he believed, by Washington—to be obstructive.[152]

The Taiwan Strait Crisis (1954–1955)

Having had to deal with the first Taiwan Strait crisis in 1954, the Eisenhower administration would not have described the Chinese leadership as accommodating. In September, China started shelling Taiwan-held offshore islands. Eisenhower and Dulles had been concerned that Jiang would try to force their hand with an attempt to make a move onto the mainland. But for reasons of credibility, as well as domestic politics, the Eisenhower administration felt it could not jettison the GMD leader. Thus,